A-A-53559A
15 December 1988
SUPERSEDES
A-A-0053559(DM)
22 July 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

JAR, SCREW CAP (Pathological Specimen)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description covers a leakproof and transparent plastic widemouth pathological specimen jar.

Salient characteristics.

Shall be a plastic jar suitable for containing, transporting and storing fluid, semi-solid and solid laboratory specimens of a questionable pathological nature.

Shall be a nominal one (1) pint capacity widemouth jar with a screw cap closure.

Shall be supplied with a jar fabricated from clear polystyrene. The polystyrene shall have sufficient optical clarity to allow for a thorough visual examination of specimen contents through the sides of the jar. The jar shall be cylindrical in shape and shall have a height of 4 ± 1/4 inches. The mouth opening shall be at least 3-1/4 inches. The wall and bottom of the jar shall have a minimum thickness of 0.040 inches. The top edge of the jar shall be sufficiently level and even to provide a leakproof closure with the screw cap closure. The jar shall be capable of resting on a flat horizontal surface without any evidence of rocking or wobbling.

Shall be supplied with a plastic or metal screw cap closure. A metal screw cap, that may be supplied, shall be suitably protected against corrosion. The outside rim of the screw cap shall have ribbed surfaces to facilitate finger gripping.

AMSC N/A FSC 6640

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The inside of the screw cap shall include a gasket that shall mate with the top edge of the jar (in closure) to provide a leakproof closure (see "Leakage testing" requirements under "Quality Assurance Provisions").

Shall be capable of holding liquids such as water, methyl alcohol solution and formaldehyde without any form of degradation due to chemical attack on the jar, screw cap or gasket.

Workmanship. The jar and screw cap closure shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing one hundred jars with screw caps, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Inspections and tests. Inspections and tests shall be conducted in accordance with commercial practice to determine compliance with specification requirements. Additional testing requirements shall be as hereinafter indicated (see "Leakage testing" requirements).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Sampling for inspections and tests. Unless otherwise indicated (see "Leakage testing" requirements) sampling for inspections and tests shall be conducted in accordance with commercial practice.

Leakage testing. The jar and screw cap closure shall be tested to assure a leakproof closure. The jar shall be filled half-full with water, and the gasketed screw cap then hand tightened or secured in place with 24 inch-pounds of torque. The jar shall be positioned on its side for at least 1/2 hour and then shaken vigorously for 15 seconds. The jar shall be re-positioned on its side for at least another four hours, and then shaken vigorously for 15 seconds. Any evidence of leakage through the screw cap, with the jar stationary or while being shaken, shall be cause for rejection. Sampling for leakage testing shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 (Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspections by Attributes) with an inspection level of S-2 and an acceptance number of zero.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable. The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U. S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/ contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

6640-01-279-2403

Ordering data. (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6640-1537

Location: Disk No. 16
ICID/JAR/SCREW/CAP/S31

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER
A-A-53559A

2 DOCUMENT TITLE
JAR, SCREW CAP (Pathological Specimen)

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION

b. ADDRESS (*Street, City, State, ZIP Code*)

4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION (*Mark one*)

- ☐ VENDOR
- ☐ USER
- ☐ MANUFACTURER
- ☐ OTHER (*Specify*)

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER (*Last, First, MI*) – Optional

b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER (*Include Area Code*) – Optional

c. MAILING ADDRESS (*Street, City, State, ZIP Code*) – Optional

8. DATE OF SUBMISSION (*YYMMDD*)

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization do[illegible] are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO 4966 WASHINGTON D C

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
ATTN: DPSC-RSTE
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101-8419

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.